

Nicolle Bekers, M.A.

Intermediate Team Faculty · Grade 4 · SY 2026-2027

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Welcome to Grade 4 Science. This syllabus is intended for you, the student, to develop a greater understanding of what we will cover, what is expected of you, and what you can expect from me. My hope this year is that students build confidence and mastery through study and hands-on labs and experiments that make the transition to 5th grade Science seamless.

Course Overview

Students will explore foundational concepts in physical, life, and earth sciences

through hands-on experiments, projects, and inquiry-based learning.

The 2026-2027 course follows **HMH Into Science Grade 4**, organized around five

NGSS-aligned units:

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1. **Unit 1: Engineering and Technology** — Students learn how engineers ask questions, define problems, and plan investigations to develop solutions. They discover how technology changes to meet the needs of people and the problems they face.
 2. **Unit 2: Plant and Animal Structure and Function** — Students explore how plant and animal structures support survival, growth, and reproduction. They develop and use models, then argue from evidence to explain how organisms' senses help them survive.
 3. **Unit 3: Energy and Communication** — Students explore how waves show that energy is transferred and how energy and information travel through waves. They investigate devices — from cell phones to satellites — that enable humans to transmit information across vast distances.
 4. **Unit 4: Shaping Landforms** — Students explore how landscapes change over time. They use models to examine the factors and processes that transform land, then construct explanations from patterns in their observations.

5. **Unit 5: Earth's Features and Resources** — Students use maps to identify

patterns in where natural hazards occur, explore ways to reduce their impact,

and learn how technology is changing how we use Earth's natural resources.

Textbook

HMH Into Science
Houghton Mifflin Harcourt

Grading Policy

- **30% Tests**
- **20% Quizzes**
- **15% Homework and Projects**
- **35% Classwork and Participation**

Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic grade book via your **Beehively** account, which will be a primary method of communicating your child's academic performance. *It will be assumed that you have seen all grades and missing assignments that are entered in Beehively.*

Homework Policy

Students are expected to **read 20 minutes every day**. In addition to the reading, other homework will be assigned. Your children's teachers will work together to ensure that the students receive a balanced homework regime aimed to create a positive learning environment that nurtures students' intellectual growth.

Assignments are expected to be written daily in a student's planner, and available on Google Calendar. Parents are expected to check the student's planners daily, support their child in time management and follow through. Late work will be accepted; however, late assignments will negatively affect students' participation grades.

Classroom Expectations

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 - Students are expected to come to class prepared and ready to learn.
 - Homework should be completed daily and turned in. Should there be a reason that the homework cannot be completed on time, the teacher should be notified in advance and a plan should be made to complete the assignment.

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- Students are expected to always try their best and participate in class.

Further, they are expected to ask questions, request clarification, and

- communicate via office hours or email as needed.

- Students are expected to respect themselves, respect others, and respect all property.

Required Materials

Students should be prepared on a daily basis with the following:

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- Science composition book
- HMH Into Science textbook
- Erasable pen, pencil, eraser and highlighter
- Glue stick and scissors
- Sticky notes
- Index cards
- Planner

Important Dates · 2026–2027

Orientation	August 12, 2026
Parent-Teacher Conferences	Fall 9/10–11, 2026 · Spring 2/19/27 (optional)
Q1 Expedition — Coconut Island	October 2, 2026
Q2 Expedition — Pearl Harbor & Ice Palace	December 11 (pending) and 14, 2026
Q3 Expedition — ‘Iolani Palace	March 5, 2027
Q4 Expedition — Sherwood Forest	June 1, 2027
School Spelling Bee	November 20, 2026
Christmas Performance	December 18, 2026
End-of-Year Awards	June 3, 2027

(All expedition dates and times subject to change.)

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith ♥!